

ELLEN EVA WILSON LUNT (JONES)

1861 - 1923

Compiled by Kris Bateman

Great Granddaughter-In-Law, Nov. 2004

Ellen Eva Wilson Lunt was born 7 Feb 1861, in Cedar City, Iron, Utah to Henry and Mary Ann Wilson Lunt. Mary Ann was wife number two of the four wives that Henry Lunt had. Ellen Eva was the 2nd daughter and child of Henry and Mary Ann's eight children.

Henry's first wife Ellen Whittaker never had children of her own and was like a second mother to all of Mary Ann's children. Ellen Eva was named after Henry Lunt's first wife Ellen Whittaker.

The year Ellen Eva (known as "Eva") was born was the same year the Civil War started.

According to Henry H. Lunt, a grandson of Henry, the Lunt Hotel and Stage Stop was located on First East and 100 North in Cedar City. It was constructed of native adobe brick and was a large two-story building with white trim. There was a big living room containing a fireplace, with eight rooms on the ground floor and eight upstairs (In addition, later there were more rooms built in the back). The house had a large porch. When the stage coaches pulled in, the travelers were unloaded near the porch, and the drivers took the coaches on the cobblestone driveway to the back of the building where there was a large barn and accommodations for thirty horses.

The Lunts had several adjoining lots on which they grew a large garden and a fruit orchard containing apples, peaches, plums and apricots. The home had an underground storage unit where meat, butter and milk was kept. There was also a cellar for the storage of fruits and vegetables. The family lived in the east section of the home. A belfry was on top of the building and the rope which was used to ring the bell hung through the house into the hallway. They rang the bell to call people to church, for funerals, and for other occasions.

All transportation was on unimproved roads and the travelers going through town put their horses in the hotel barn. The Stage Stop advertised with a sign on main street saying that there was a "house of entertainment one block east, good

accommodations for travelers, reasonable rates, hay, grain and stabling, and there was a telegraph office located in the hotel." All the Lunt children inherited good singing voices from their parents and, undoubtedly, were part of the entertainment.

The family members helped in the cooking and serving the food. All the girls and wives were involved in this part of the service to the hotel guests. There was a great deal of laundry and cleaning that was necessary to keep the rooms ready, so there was always plenty of work for everyone in the family. The boys helped care for the garden and the orchard, as well as work on the farm.

Henry and Mary Ann's children were reaching the age where they were starting to court. Two sons of Thomas and Sage Treharne Jones were spending quite a lot of time at the Lunt home with Henrietta and Eva, their two oldest children. Henrietta married Lehi Willard Jones 13 Feb 1878 and Eva married Jed three months later.

Ellen Eva Wilson Lunt and Thomas Jedediah Jones were married on 21 May 1878. Eva was 17 years old and Jed was 20 years old. *(Source: old family group sheets and records York Jones found & Henry Lunt Biography by Evelyn K. & York Jones) They were sealed in the St. George Temple a year later on 21 May 1879. Their 2 1/2 month old baby boy, Lamoni Lunt Jones, was also sealed to them on that same day in the St. George Temple. *(Source: St. George Temple Records)

After Jed and Eva were married, Jed built a log cabin. Soon there were one or two lumber additions made. However, he was looking to the future and purchased a lot to build a larger home for his increasing family. One child about each three years. By work and trading he accumulated the necessary lumber and materials to start the home.

Right at that time came the invitation to the community to establish a branch of the University of Utah, if a suitable building could be provided. One had been started as the "Ward Hall", but was far from complete. So Jed gave them all the lumber and other materials he had on hand to complete the building for a school. Next thing he did was start all over again to accumulate materials for his home. Well, he was about ready to start building when a directive came from Salt Lake City, that unless a separate and adequate building were

provided by the opening of school term "next fall", all funds from the State would be withdrawn for a school in Cedar. There went the materials for the home again. Jed was appointed as Chairman to construct the new and "adequate" building. (Source: Elton L. Jones history of his dad Thomas Jedediah Jones)

Eva and Jed did build a home and lived in Cedar City, Utah, in the house that stood on the north side of 200 North and 300 West, which was their family home. Eva lived there until she passed away and Jed lived there until 1924. Jed and Eva lived on the west side of the house and H. Marvin and Lucy lived in the east part. *(Source: Henry Marvin Jones Autobiography)

Jed and Eva had a ranch in the mountains in what is known as Moots Hollow, which is over the hill north of the College Ranch and Woods Ranch and at the base of Cedar Breaks. Eva and some of the kids spent most of the summer up there as Jed would move part of the family up there each summer to dairy. They would milk 25 or 30 cows and make cheese and butter. Henry "Marvin" stated that fond memories remain of how we all liked the trimmings of the cheese, a process in where making cheese we would turn it after it had been in a press all day.

As Thomas Jedediah was a builder and was busy in town, he didn't spend much time at the ranch, but he would come up often to bring supplies and see how everyone was getting along. Eva and Jed's older daughters usually stayed in town to keep the home in order, so it was usually Eva, Cora, Jed (their son), and Marvin who stayed up there on the ranch. There was a real good spring just above the house which provided them with plenty of good cold water. They always had a good garden as every-thing would grow in that rich black soil. *(Source: Henry Marvin Jones Autobiography)

Ellen Eva and Jed were the parents of ten children. Lamoni Lunt, Randall Lunt, Sage Lunt, Mary Ann Lunt, Eva Cora, Urania Maude, Jedediah Lunt, Henry Marvin, Elton Lunt, and Preston Lunt Jones. Lamoni died [after] serving a mission.

The following information is all from grandchildren of Ellen Eva:

Ellen Eva would make jelly and boil it for exactly 10 minutes and then take some in a spoon and hold it up, and if it came off in only 2 drops, no more no less, then it would set up and be good jelly. *(Source: Memory of Eva Stucki Guyette, related

to her by her mother Cora).

Ellen Eva always wore dresses to her ankles and also always wore a white waist apron that went to the bottom of her dress. She sat on her front porch in a rocking chair an awful lot. She was very quiet and talked very little.

Eva always remembered and wanted to try to feed you something when you were there. Thurma remembers sometimes staying with Ellen Eva while Jed went to town for the mail.

Ellen Eva had had problems that were never identified after the birth of her last child. When Ellen Eva passed away they had her propped up in a bed in the living room for a couple of days before her funeral. They had bottles of ice water all around her, because there was no embalming available to preserve the body until the funeral. Thurma is quite sure that Jed made Eva's casket. *(Source: Memories of Therma Jones Brown) Ellen Eva sitting on the front porch in a rocking chair, ...rocking, with her hands in her lap, and being very quiet was a memory also shared by Norma. *(Source: Memory of Norma McDonald Thorley Dent).

Ellen Eva was ill quite a bit of her life and was sick the last ten years of her life. She had several strokes before she passed away on 23 June 1923 at the age of 62. Jed loved her and took care of her until her death. *(Source: Memory of Homer Jones). She was carried away in a black horse drawn hearse. Austin believes that it was the same hearse that is now on display in the Iron Mission Museum in Cedar City, Utah, except it is now painted white instead of black. *(Source: Memory of Austin Jones).

Family information and rumors say that Ellen Eva suffered from dementia in the last years of her life. Afton Jones Bateman doesn't recall her mother (Lucy Esplin Jones) telling her anything about her grandmother Ellen Eva. Lucy Esplin Jones had, however, talked to Lena Esplin Woodbury, Lucy's youngest sister, about Ellen Eva. Lena was a professional counselor and stated to Afton once - that given the knowledge we have now, Ellen Eva probably suffered from a chemical imbalance that resulted in depression after her last child Preston was born. Lena believed Ellen Eva could have been helped, had the medical knowledge we now have been available back then. *(Source: Memory of Afton Jones Bateman).